INSTITUTE FOR INFECTIOUS DISEASES

As the Avengers rush to stop Crossbones in Lagos, they find themselves at the Institute for Infectious Diseases. Much like the *Lemurian Star* takedown seen at the start of Marvel's *Captain America: The Winter Soldier,* the Russo brothers sought to open *Civil War* with a plausible, high-stakes set piece. "One of the things we were talking about in building the opening of the film was making Crossbones a terrifying figure," Nate Moore says. "Part and parcel to that is giving him an agenda that was both real-world and really, really scary. The Russo brothers never like things to just be linear, so our goal was to sort of suggest he'd been robbing police stations for weapons—but then we find out he's been doing something much worse. What's worse than guns and grenades? Biological weaponry."

While the Institute for Infectious Diseases is a fictional location, the filmmakers had a distinct agenda for choosing its geographical location in Nigeria. "We knew we wanted to introduce the idea of Wakanda and the Black Panther into the narrative," Moore explains. "Therefore it made sense to set it in an African country where there could be Wakandans. It's harder to tell that same story if you're in, say, Amsterdam, and Crossbones robs something terrible and accidentally kills Wakandans there—that feels a little more like a stretch than a neighboring country. It was always an alchemy of 'what's the right opening for the film,' 'what's going to set up Crossbones as a big threat that *has* to be stopped,' and 'how do we organically include Wakandans in the devastation that takes place.'"



45 Manuel Plank-Jorge keyframe.